judgment of the Court of Appeals for the Second Circuit is affirmed.

It is so ordered.

JUSTICE SOTOMAYOR, with whom JUSTICE KAGAN joins, concurring in the judgment.

The First Step Act of 2018 expanded district courts' authority to "reduce [a] term of imprisonment" upon a finding that "extraordinary and compelling reasons warrant such a reduction" and that the reduced sentence is consistent with traditional sentencing factors. 18 U. S. C. §3582(c)(1)(A). For many of the reasons explained in JUSTICE JACKSON's dissenting opinion, the Court's decision interpreting that provision today is wrong. The majority improperly narrows the scope of §3582(c)(1)(A) based on tenuous inferences drawn from the federal habeas statutes. Its habeas-based rule distorts and expands the Court's habeas-channeling cases, creating an atextual limitation found nowhere in §3582(c)(1)(A). In doing so, it superimposes a technical, and likely unworkable, habeas analysis on top of a sentence-reduction framework that broadly calls for holistic review. Moreover, the rule adopted today risks shutting out meritorious claims for a sentence reduction simply because they might resemble, in some amorphous way, a claim that might call into question a sentence or conviction.

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Even so, the judgment below should be affirmed on a different, far simpler ground, which follows much more naturally from the statute before the Court: A motion for compassionate release cannot justify a reduced sentence if it relies solely on facts a court already considered in imposing the initial sentence, rather than any changed circumstances that developed after sentencing.

In general, a "court may not modify a term of imprisonment once it has been imposed." §3582(c). Section 3582(c)(1)(A) authorizes a limited departure from that rule of finality when "extraordinary and compelling reasons" arise so as

to "warrant . . . a reduction" of the sentence imposed. For a reason to "warrant" a change of a sentence, however, it cannot have been a consideration that was part of the initial sentencing determination to begin with. At the very least, changing a sentence already imposed under § 3582(c)(1)(A) requires something to have changed, after sentencing, in a way that alters the sentencing calculus. See, *e. g.*, *Setser* v. *United States*, 566 U. S. 231, 242–243 (2012) (explaining that § 3582(c)(1)(A) provides for relief when "'developments that take place after the first sentencing' produc[e] unfairness to the defendant" (citation omitted)). Otherwise, district courts would have indefinite authority to revise sentences already imposed based on information and arguments that were previously considered and rejected. Such authority would seriously diminish the finality of sentences required by § 3582(c).

The District Court's grant of relief here ran afoul of this principle. Petitioner Joe Fernandez has been litigating the issues at the core of his § 3582(c)(1)(A) motion since his trial. From the start, Fernandez has contended that the evidence against him was weak and that the prosecution failed to prove beyond a reasonable doubt that he (and not someone else) committed the murders for which he was convicted. He raised these issues at his trial, see *ante*, at 415, at his sentencing, see App. 57–62, in a motion to reconsider his sentence, see *ante*, at 415–416, and in a postconviction motion under 28 U. S. C. § 2255, even though "[n]o new evidence had surfaced," *ante*, at 416–417. Each effort failed in the trial court and on appeal. Yet these same arguments finally found success under § 3582(c)(1)(A) based on the District Court's renewed feelings of "'doub[t]'" and "'disquiet'" about the original trial evidence supporting Fernandez's jury verdict. *Ante*, at 418.*

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*As the majority notes, *ante*, at 418, n. 1, the District Court also relied on a sentencing disparity between Fernandez and some of his codefendants in granting relief, but the Second Circuit rejected that separate basis for

This grant of relief was inappropriate given the absence of any postsentencing developments, and the Court needed to go no further to affirm the decision below. Unfortunately, bad facts often make bad law, and so they did today. Correctly perceiving a problem with the District Court's grant of relief, the majority responds with a rule that goes far beyond both what is needed to resolve this case and, worse, what the text and relevant precedents can bear. Because I do not agree with the majority's reasoning in support of its decision to affirm the decision below, I concur only in the judgment of the Court.

JUSTICE JACKSON, dissenting.

Section 3582(c)(1)(A) of Title 18 of the U. S. Code—known as the compassionate-release statute—authorizes district courts to reduce federal prison sentences under specified circumstances. This case is about the scope of that authority. By its terms, the compassionate-release statute is flexible, permitting sentence reductions for "extraordinary and compelling reasons." 18 U. S. C. § 3582(c)(1)(A)(i). The breadth of this language is no accident: It reflects Congress's intent to preserve some of the traditional discretion afforded to district courts to ensure just treatment of defendants in criminal cases.

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Today, the Court arbitrarily restricts that discretion by grafting an atextual rule onto § 3582(c)(1)(A). It holds that a district court may not base its "extraordinary and compelling" findings on any reason that "collaterally attacks the validity" of the prisoner's conviction. *Ante*, at 415. Such "attacks," the majority says, must be brought through motions for habeas relief under 28 U. S. C. § 2255. *Ibid.* But this restriction comes of out nowhere—it finds no support in the statute's text or history, nor can it be justified by our precedents.

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relief on grounds unrelated to the question that this Court granted certiorari to review, 104 F. 4th 420, 428–429 (2024).